

SME CONNECT

Unified Workflow Automation Platform for SMEs

Group No – 03

Group Members –

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1. Problem Statement

Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) form a critical part of the economy, yet most of them continue to rely on multiple disconnected software tools — spreadsheets, CRM systems, billing software, and accounting applications — to manage their daily operations. Because these systems are not integrated with one another, employees are forced to manually transfer and re-enter the same data across platforms.

This manual, repetitive process leads to several recurring issues:

- **Significant administrative workload** on staff who could otherwise focus on core business tasks
- **Time wastage** due to repeated data entry across systems
- **Human errors and duplicate records**, since manual entry is inherently error-prone
- **Delayed business operations**, as data synchronization is not real-time
- **Increased operational costs**, resulting from wasted labor hours and error correction
- **Reduced overall productivity** across departments

While integration platforms do exist to solve this problem, most of them are **expensive, technically complex, or built for large enterprises** with dedicated IT teams and larger budgets. This makes them impractical and inaccessible for SMEs, who typically lack the technical expertise and financial resources to adopt such solutions. As a result, a large segment of businesses remains stuck with fragmented, manually operated software ecosystems.

2. Need for the Proposed Solution

The gap between what SMEs need and what the current market offers creates a clear need for a lightweight, affordable, and easy-to-use integration solution. Specifically, there is a need for a platform that:

- **Requires no programming knowledge**, so non-technical staff and business owners can configure it themselves
- **Is affordable**, unlike enterprise-grade iPaaS (Integration Platform as a Service) tools that charge based on complex enterprise pricing tiers

- **Supports commonly used SME tools** — spreadsheets, CRM, billing, and accounting software — rather than being built around large, specialized enterprise systems
- **Automates repetitive data transfer tasks**, reducing manual effort and the associated risk of human error
- **Enables faster, more reliable business operations** by keeping data synchronized across systems in near real-time
- **Scales with the business**, allowing SMEs to add new workflows and integrations as they grow, without needing to re-architect their systems

Without such a solution, SMEs will continue to bear unnecessary administrative costs, operational delays, and data inconsistency issues that directly limit their growth and competitiveness — especially against larger competitors who can afford full-scale integration infrastructure.

3. *Scope*

The scope of SME Connect includes:

In Scope:

- A no-code / low-code workflow builder allowing users to define automation rules (trigger → action) without writing code
- Integration support for commonly used SME software categories: spreadsheets (e.g., Google Sheets/Excel), CRM systems, billing/invoicing tools, and accounting applications
- Data synchronization engine to keep records consistent across connected platforms
- A simple, intuitive dashboard/UI for configuring, monitoring, and managing workflows
- Error logging and notification system to alert users of failed or incomplete syncs
- Role-based access so business owners can control who sets up or modifies workflows
- Affordable pricing model suited to SME budgets (e.g., subscription tiers based on usage/workflow count)

Out of Scope (for initial version):

- Deep customization requiring scripting/coding (target audience is non-technical users)
- Support for highly specialized or niche enterprise software not commonly used by SMEs
- Complex enterprise-grade features like advanced data governance, multi-region compliance, or large-scale enterprise resource planning (ERP) integrations
- On-premise deployment (initial focus is cloud-based/SaaS delivery)